and that is why Khan and Sandhu's nexus is bothering me/ Jindal contended.

It was well past lunchtime when Bhardwaj asked Jindal for aggressive surveillance on Khan and Sandhu.

'What is in your mind about the operation?' Bhardwaj finally said.

'I need an officer posted undercover at the London embassy to coordinate with Clarke. He would just be a go-between. I will control the operation from Paris/ Jindal suggested.

'I hope your special operation pays off. Come back with an intelligence coup, not a disaster/ Bhardwaj said sceptically. No one could have guessed from his tone that Jindal was his favourite agent because of the younger man's methodical selection of targets and efficient handling of work.

This was the beginning of Operation Hornet.

Jindal had already identified the spy to be posted in London. The officer codenamed Mohan Narayanan had earlier worked in Prague where, under the tutelage of Bhardwaj, he had carried out several operations. Narayanan was articulate, well-informed on militancy and the European landscape and above all, very charming. He could spin story after story without parting with even an iota of valuable intelligence. He could speak German and French besides a little Punjabi and could easily assimilate himself in an alien culture.

Operation Hornet was divided into two distinct areas. Intelligence collection and interpretation were the tasks for Narayanan and Clarke, while the covert operation was Jindal's